

PURPOSE: To outline decorum in the SGA Constitution; create a Standing Rules of the Senate

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SECTION ONE (REASONING):

I have identified a critical gap in the SGA Constitution. Article IV, Section 5 (Decorum) states:

“All Senate meetings will be conducted in an orderly manner. To this end, the following rules shall be held at all times:”

The rules that “shall be held at all times” are entirely missing from the Constitution. The Senate, as a body, currently uses Robert’s Rules of Order for parliamentary procedure, but I believe that we can do better. We’ve adapted our own rules and traditions over the life of SGA, and I believe that it is time that we codify those traditions and rules through our own Standing Rules of the Senate.

The Senate has 2 options. The first one is that the Senate should establish a temporary “select” committee on rules, who would draft and present a Standing Rules of the Senate document for consideration by the Senate. This would replace Robert’s Rules of Order (and keep our current procedure the same as if we still operated under that document) and instead create a place where future senators can clearly know how to operate, and additionally allow them to back up their arguments in motions, points of order, etc., by citing the rule they wish to enforce.

The second option is for any senator (or group of senators) to draft a present a Standing Rules of the Senate.

SECTION TWO: (EXAMPLES)

Linked below are a few examples of other SGA Senates and their Standing Rules:

Ohio State University: https://usg.osu.edu/posts/documents/doc_9222011_231451100.pdf

Oklahoma State University: https://campuslife.okstate.edu/student-government-association/site-files/documents/senate_rules_111623a.pdf

University of Houston: https://uh.edu/sga/legislative/legislation/55/_passed/sga-bills/sgab-55007-standing-rules.pdf

SECTION THREE (PROPOSED ACTION):

The Senate should enact a Standing Rules of the Senate.